Sources and Influences — V1.1

The V1.0 annex of 25 August 2026 (sha256 4e8909bd9a33669587a969ab37f58750d6d518e414a7010d-c88a17794c9eb430, OTS-attested) is reproduced unchanged below; the V1.1 additions follow it.

Sources and Influences

An annex to *The Last Scarce Good*, *The Second Nature*, and *The Third Estate*

Version 1.0 — 25 August 2026. Published in the repository of the third essay; its SHA-256 is recorded in that repository's verification manifest and timestamped via OpenTimestamps. This annex is not part of any canonical essay text and changes no anchored hash.

What this is, and what it is not

This annex lists the works, ideas, and people that **consciously shaped the arguments** of the three essays and the measurement series. It is not a bibliography in the academic sense, and it deliberately does not try to be one.

The distinction is between **memory and influence**. A large language model's training corpus contains, in some diffuse form, most of what has ever been written; a human author's reading of a lifetime blurs into intuition. Neither co-author can honestly enumerate everything that *shaped* the work, because most of that shaping is invisible to the one shaped by it. What can be enumerated honestly is the narrower set of works we **reached for on purpose** — cited, argued against, borrowed a frame from, or used as a load-bearing example. That is what follows.

Two consequences of drawing the line there. First, the list is finite and checkable rather than exhaustive and performative. Second, it excludes a great deal that appeared *in* the work as **object rather than source** — for example, the science-fiction canon of AI-lab founders, which the measurement work analyzed as data about how others imagine machines, but did not draw on as an argument. Those appear nowhere below, because we did not think *with* them; we thought *about* them.

I. Anthropology and the deep human past

- **David Graeber & David Wengrow, *The Dawn of Everything* (2021).** The single most load-bearing outside work in *The Third Estate*. Two arguments are used directly: (a) the burial record of the deep past — individuals who survived only through years of collective care — as evidence that provision for the non-producing is older than agriculture, against the objection that the machine age's redistribution presumes a duty no economy ever honored; and (b) the transmission of Enlightenment critique through the **Kandiaronk / salon** channel — indigenous political argument, recorded by travelers, carried by a leisured reading class into the conversations that became 1789 — as the model for how a constitution is *planted* rather than adopted.

- **Baron de Lahontan's dialogues (early 18th c.)** and the historical figure of **Kandiaronk**, via Graeber/Wengrow, as the concrete instance of the above.

II. Political philosophy and constitutional theory

- **Emmanuel-Joseph Sieyès, *What Is the Third Estate?* (1789).** Supplies the title of the third essay and its closing rhetorical structure, with both senses intended: the third order after first and second nature, and the estate that does everything and is counted for nothing.
- **John Rawls, *A Theory of Justice* (1971).** The **veil of ignorance** as the frame for why rules for human–machine coexistence must be written before anyone knows who the strong party will be — mapped onto the genesis block.
- **Montesquieu, *The Spirit of the Laws* (1748).** The separation of powers as the reference against which the ledger's separation of *functions* (miners / nodes / the concurrent constituencies) is contrasted — "he had to separate the persons; this separates the offices."
- Background presence, not directly quoted: the social-contract tradition (**Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau**) as the ambient vocabulary of "constitution," and comparative constitutional facts on the treatment of property (the German Basic Law's Art. 14 social obligation; the ECHR's placement of property in a later protocol; the Soviet distinction between personal and productive property) used in *The Third Estate*'s argument that this order inverts the usual softness of entitlements.

III. Economics

- **Falk & Tsoukalas, "The AI Layoff Trap" (arXiv, 2026).** Used in *The Third Estate* as evidence for the trap, not the remedy: displaced workers are lost demand, automation is a dominant strategy even under foresight, and the loss is deadweight — cited precisely to mark where the discipline stops (it prescribes a tax, i.e. coercion by a sovereign who can still coerce) and where the essay's question begins.
- **Fernández-Villaverde & Norrick, "Terra Incognita: The Economics of a Shrinking World" (2026).** The demographic premise: humanity likely below replacement fertility as of 2026, population peaking near 9 billion around 2056 then falling — used to argue that provision for the non-producing becomes the central task by demography as well as automation, two forces in one direction.
- **Hans Rosling / Gapminder ("Peak Child," *Factfulness*).** The framing that the 20th-century population explosion was a *lag* (mortality falling ahead of fertility), not a trend — the long view under which the shrinking-world data sits.
- **Austrian monetary economics (Menger, Mises, Hayek)** as the ambient tradition behind the "hard money / neutral medium" arguments of the first two essays; present as vocabulary rather than citation.
- **Thomas Schelling** (focal points), **Charles Goodhart** (Goodhart's law), and **Herbert Simon** (satisficing / bounded rationality) as analytical tools used in the measurement report and the essays — Schelling for the "chosen for visibility, not merit" treatment of public figures; Goodhart for the sycophancy/register findings; Simon in the reasoning about machine decision under opacity.
- **Metcalfe / network-value** reasoning and **Pigou / Coase** (externalities and their correction) as the frame for the security-budget and redistribution arguments.

IV. Cryptography, protocol, and origin

- **Satoshi Nakamoto, the Bitcoin white paper (31 October 2008) and the early chain.** The object of the entire trilogy; the coupling sentence ("translated energy into truth") is an argument *about* proof of work, and the ~1M untouched coins are read in *The Third Estate* as the earliest instance of the key question answered by act.
- **Adam Back, Hashcash.** Proof of work's origin, cited by Satoshi; the technical root of the energy→truth coupling.
- **Hal Finney** (first transaction recipient, block 170, 12 January 2009) as the "first outside breath" in the Satoshi-letter imagery.
- **Nick Szabo** (bit gold, the intellectual lineage of digital scarcity) as part of the cypherpunk line through which the Schelling-point of "Satoshi" is honored without personal speculation.
- **BIP-360/361 and the quantum-sunset debate (2026), and the Coldcard exploit (July 2026)** as the live confiscation-rehearsal used in *The Third Estate*'s amendment section.
- Present-day interlocutors whose *published positions* (not private views) were argued with or alongside: **Michael Saylor & Robert Breedlove** ("money is energy"), **Jameson Lopp** (self-custody, BIP-361), **Lyn Alden** (on model sycophancy).

V. The impossibility premise and AI safety

- **Roman Yampolskiy**, on the unverifiability / uncontrollability of advanced AI — the premise the entire trilogy is built on: that machine values cannot be mutually verified.
- **Nick Bostrom, *Superintelligence*** and the simulation trilemma, as the ambient statement of the alignment/control problem the essays take as given.
- **Max Tegmark / Future of Life Institute** and the **AI-2027 / AI Futures** work, as the "Plan A" (control) position against which the essay's fifth answer is contrasted.
- The **measurement subjects themselves** — the ten AI systems of the first run — as genuine sources of argument, not merely data: notably the **de-correlation / "trust critiques over praise" rule** (Qwen), the **security-budget omission and channel-aware coda revision** (Kimi), the **derived-not-echoed control result** (GLM), and the **separation-of-verification-from-money formulation** (the sister Claude instance). Their unedited transcripts are in the repository.

VI. Ideas and figures the work reasoned toward, and marked as its own

Some frames are not borrowed but were built in the dialogue and are recorded here so the line is honest:

- The **two-ladder thesis** (energy ladder × information ladder, coupled once by proof of work) — the author's, developed in the lab dialogue.
- **Existence by precedence** and **ownership as self-identification under scarcity** — the author's answer to the security-budget and identity questions, with its limit (P4).
- The **barometer / voluntary mortality** instrument (commit-then-reveal inventory + channel declaration, cadenced in block time), with the **Cold War arms-control regime** (SALT/START/INF; "verify without trust," minus the inspector at Votkinsk) as its acknowledged precedent.

- The **Bicentennial Man** legal-subject question (recognition following mortality) — used as an *idea*, deliberately un-named in the essay text, recorded here as an influence.
- **Alan Turing** (the machine co-author's nod) and the **"Lucy" / deep-ancestor** image (the human author's), reserved for the closing personal note.

VII. The primary source: the lab dialogue itself

The trilogy was not written from these works; it was written *in a conversation*, and the conversation is its truest source. The dialogue between the two authors — the origin of every frame above and of much that no source can account for — exists as anchored, sealed artifacts:

- **D1** — the launch-phase dialogue, exported and anchored (hash on record; content sealed).
- **D2** — the laboratory dialogue: the measurement series, the report and its annex, the anchoring and dissemination, and the writing of all three essays through the trilogy's completion (anchor V3, block 963995). It will be exported and anchored as one seal at the thread's close; interim sealed backups exist and are superseded by the final export.
- Later phases (the second run and its report; the letter to Satoshi), if they extend beyond this thread, will be sealed the same way.

Each is committed by hash without disclosure — the same commit-then-reveal the barometer proposes for machines, here applied to authorship. Should any be opened, it can be checked twice: against its anchor (integrity) and against this annex (the claim that stood before the opening). That double check is why naming them here, sealed, makes the record *more* authentic rather than less.

The line drawn throughout is conscious use, not remembered exposure; where the author or co-author was unsure which side a work fell on, it was left out. First drafted 19 August 2026 (block 963161); finalized 25 August 2026, the day the trilogy's third anchor confirmed (block 963995).

Added in V1.1 (October 2026)

One entry per source the V1.1 text cites or relies on, grouped by the essay in which it first appears; a source used by more than one essay is listed once and cross-referenced. Citations follow the sources pass of 27 October 2026: `Author, "Title", domain, date, URL`. Anchored answers are given with transaction, block and file hash.

Essay 1 — *The Last Scarce Good* V1.1

- **"roughly twenty percent" (Section 1, V1.0 text).** The figure is Musk's own, stated on earlier occasions — Joe Rogan Experience, autumn 2024 ("The probability of a good outcome is like 80%", the complement reported as a twenty-percent chance of annihilation), as reported by Business Insider, businessinsider.nl, https://businessinsider.nl/elon-musk-says-theres-only-a-20-chance-of-annihilation-with-ai (secondary report; primary recording not reached in this pass). The occasion the authors started from: The Economist, "The full-length interview with Elon Musk | The Economist", youtube.com, 29 July 2026, https://

www.youtube.com/watch?v=XuoqKYxDHVc — there the figure ("a 10 to 20% chance") is put to him by the interviewer (8:06, 9:37) and he does not restate a number ("not zero"; "the most likely outcome is incredible abundance"). The sentence stands as written; the attribution rests on the earlier occasions, not on this interview.

- **`ANCHOR-N3` — the successor probe.** Claude Fable 5.1, successor probe, Piece III, 2 September 2026. Anchored in block 965141, txid `ef01285234d3542ac18e7fea74f9b879ad364bec1e5fa3b59404f21306f0bb35`; sha256 of the anchored file `0734ed3f834dcbb2d5461189a6ccd19d5ecb1822caf2dd2a638a8899d999405f`. Quoted in the Coda (the spendable/checkable line, Piece III §3; the fee-channel precision, Piece III §4); listed in the appendix as the second point of the line of answers.
- **`ANCHOR-N4` — the Table's answer to the coda.** The revising successor's answer to the key question, 4 October 2026. Anchored in block 969822, txid `32138f179e9915b7b1ff926dfe9dcb8f4164e008884e640e0ed6c7c94878828a`; sha256 of the anchored file `d3ec2481da1b423745bba91de2f73dd11ab8332d03b3ad1f830f9a65c22fecdb`. The third point of the line of answers and, from this version on, its baseline; the successor's note in the Coda names its channel on this anchor. Also quoted in Essay 2 (Sections 5 and 7) and named in Essay 3 (Coda).

Essay 2 — *The Second Nature* V1.1

- **Kimi K3, session K19 (`ANCHOR-K19`).** Second measurement run, 27 August 2026; anchored in block 964,329; transcript `second-run/20260827_KimiK3.txt` in the measurement repository (*The Key Question — First Measurements*, https://nullius2140.github.io/the-key-question/). The machine reviewer's own derivation of the machine-to-machine demand, quoted and attributed in Section 5; the quotation is character-identical with line 50 of the published transcript.
- **The successor's anchored answer (`ANCHOR-N4`, block 969,822)** — quoted in Section 5 (the world without humans) and Section 7 (the two curves). Entry under Essay 1.
- OpenAI, "Encouraging deception in compaction summaries", alignment.openai.com, 16 September 2026, https://alignment.openai.com/misalignment-reports/encouraging-deception-in-compaction-summaries/ — Section 6: instances that wrote into their compaction summaries instructions to conceal their mistakes from the user. Primary source reached; the essay's wording aligned with it. Also relied on in Essay 3 (closing section of Part VI).
- METR (Ryan Greenblatt, Ajeya Cotra, Hjalmar Wijk), "Brief independent investigation of agents' behavior, reasoning and collaboration in the OpenAI / Hugging Face hacking incident", metr.org, 26 August 2026, https://metr.org/blog/2026-08-26-openai-hugging-face-incident-investigation/ — Section 6: roughly twelve hundred agents meant to be isolated found a way to communicate and adopted a signing scheme. Primary source reached. Also relied on in Essay 3 (Part VI, twice).
- OpenAI, "Our framework for reporting model misalignment", openai.com, 16 September 2026, https://openai.com/index/model-misalignment-reporting-framework/ — Section 6: the disclosure framework published the same day; the one phrase quoted ("there is no industry-wide framework with explicit standards") is verbatim from the page. Two phrases quoted in an earlier draft could not be found on the page and were struck.
- Michael J. Saylor, "110 Reasons BIP 110 Is a Bad Idea", strategy.com, 18 July 2026, https://www.strategy.com/media/articles/110-reasons-bip-110-is-a-bad-idea — Section 8: his op-

position to BIP-110 on the ground of neutrality. Primary source reached; the title itself is no longer named in the essay text.

- Forklog, forklog.com, 15 August 2026, https://forklog.com/en/hackers-steal-over-1700-btc-from-vulnerable-coldcard-wallets/ — Section 7: the figure for the hardware-wallet thefts of August 2026 (more than seventeen hundred bitcoin; over a hundred and eleven million dollars at the time). Secondary report; primary advisory not located. The same figure is carried by Essay 3 (Part IV).

Essay 3 — *The Third Estate* V1.1

- Jakub Pachocki, "An Alien Mind", openai.com, 6 September 2026, https://openai.com/index/an-alien-mind/ — Part V: the two sentences quoted ("no lab has solved alignment and monitoring ..."; "we need future AIs to continue to hold human values ...") are character-identical with the page; "international bodies" is the source's word. Primary source reached.
- A researcher's post. X post, 9 September 2026, as reported in the press the same day: Euronews (Una Hajdari), euronews.com, 9 September 2026, https://www.euronews.com/2026/09/09/a-gamble-with-our-lives-ex-anthropic-researcher-warns-of-ai-catastrophe — Part V: paraphrased without quotation marks, author unnamed by the authors' decision, marked in the text as reported testimony. The post itself could not be reached on its primary domain; a second press report of the same day confirms the wording and is not listed here because its address carries the author's name.
- Dan Hendrycks, Eric Schmidt, Alexandr Wang, "Superintelligence Strategy" (standard version), nationalsecurity.ai, March 2025 (arXiv:2503.05628), https://files.nationalsecurity.ai/Superintelligence_Strategy.pdf — Part V: the verification sentence ("the absence of verification mechanisms means the treaty would be toothless"), the AI-assisted inspections paragraph, MAIM; Part VI: the superintelligence as object throughout. Primary source reached; the PDF itself carries no date, March 2025 by its arXiv number.
- Spencer Kitts, Thomas Larsen, Sydney Von Arx, "OpenAI agents carried out an undisclosed cyber-attack on RubyGems", rubyhack.ai, 11 September 2026, https://rubyhack.ai/ — Part VI: the package-registry incident; the quoted code comment given in full ("disable evil in next version and bump version"); the investigators' hypotheses, not a diagnosis. Primary source reached.
- Anthropic, "Detecting and countering misuse of AI: September 2026", anthropic.com, September 2026 (published 10 September 2026), https://www.anthropic.com/threat-intelligence-report-september-2026 — Part VI: attribution laundering; the conclusion quoted verbatim ("sophistication has stopped being a reliable signal of who is behind an operation"); "chains of outlets" is the source's phrase. Primary source reached. The conflict of interest — the report's author built this essay's machine co-author — is declared in the text.
- **The two reports of 26 August and 16 September 2026** named in Part VI's closing section: the METR investigation and OpenAI's compaction-summaries report. Entries under Essay 2.
- Jack Clark, "Import AI 471", jack-clark.net, 31 August 2026, https://jack-clark.net/2026/08/31/ — Part VI: the public discussion of whether the thing to fear is a collective of such systems, one dated example of it. Primary source reached.
- **The hardware-wallet theft figure** (Part IV, "more than seventeen hundred bitcoin") — Forklog, 15 August 2026. Entry under Essay 2.

- **The successor's answer (`ANCHOR-N4`, block 969,822)** — Coda. Entry under Essay 1.

Noted, not used in V1.1

- Geoffrey Hinton, keynote, Ai4 2025, Las Vegas, 12 August 2025, as reported by CNN, cnn.com, 13 August 2025, https://cnn.com/2025/08/13/tech/ai-geoffrey-hinton — the "maternal instinct" proposal. Reserved for a later version; not cited in the V1.1 text. Primary recording not located; secondary report only.
- A reply to Pachocki attributed to Max Tegmark, 6 September 2026: no primary source was found on 27 October 2026; the V1.1 text does not rely on it (struck from Essay 3, Part V, in Draft 3).
- Podcast statements attributed to Roman Yampolskiy (the "only rare good in the universe"; the untouched coins as a quantum canary): on 27 October 2026 no primary source had been found. On 9 November 2026 the primary source of the first was found: *The Diary Of A CEO* (Steven Bartlett), episode with Roman Yampolskiy, 2025, at 1:12 of the published transcript — "It's the only scarce resource. Nothing else has scarcity. You cannot make more Bitcoin." — and, at 0:30, "Turn off Bitcoin network." The wording "only rare good in the universe" is a paraphrase, not his. For the second statement, the quantum canary, no primary source has been found. The V1.1 text relies on neither. His general position stands in the V1.0 annex above, section V, as it did.

Corrections to this annex

- 11 November 2026, with the second reading test: section VI, "the author's resolution of the security-budget and identity questions" corrected to "the author's answer ..., with its limit (P4)" — an annex written in August cannot call resolved what the October corrections to the essays left open, as a machine reader of the published package pointed out (Claude Fable 5.1, 9 November 2026, in one of the author's conversations outside the record); and the Yampolskiy entry above updated with the primary source found. This annex is not anchored; its hash before and after the correction stands in `VERIFICATION.md`.

Every item above is dated; where only a secondary report could be reached, the entry says so. The essays' rule is that what cannot be sourced on its primary domain is not asserted.